Alex's plan

Replace the moisturizer first. Finish CeraVe cleanser, then try lower-cost Aveeno. Keep sunscreen and hold new treatments.

REPLACE

CeraVe PM

Facial Moisturizing Lotion

$18.00 / 3 fl oz

Product page



WITH

Vanicream

Daily Facial Moisturizer

$16.00 / 3 fl oz

Product page



Your consultation note

Your CeraVe moisturizes well, but it keeps stinging and you've started skipping it. I'd like you to try Vanicream Daily Facial in its place. It gives us a different moisturizing formula while keeping one product for morning and evening. The aim is to keep your cheeks comfortable without the stinging, heavy finish or makeup problems you've described.

- Keep your cleanser and sunscreen unchanged while trying it.
- After the initial small-area test, notice how it feels when you apply it, whether your cheeks feel dry later, and how your makeup wears.
- If it stings or irritates your skin, stop and let me know so we can reassess.

User experiences are self-selected reports, not comparative trials; older formulas may differ.

Both prices are illustrative for design review. The seller, size and final total require confirmation before payment.

CeraVe PM formula Vanicream formula User comparison User experiences

Formula comparison

CeraVe PM and Vanicream Daily Facial Moisturizer

INGREDIENT	CERAVE PM	VANICREAM
Niacinamide	Contains it	Not in listed formula

Vanicream leaves this out, which changes the formula you are trying. Your sunscreen contains niacinamide and you tolerate it, so I'm not asking you to avoid the ingredient everywhere. We're looking for a moisturizer that feels comfortable, without assuming we know what caused the stinging.

Squalane	Not in listed formula	Contains it

Squalane helps soften skin and contributes to how the lotion spreads and feels. CeraVe uses other emollients for these jobs. I'm choosing this different blend as a candidate for comfortable, soft-feeling cheeks without the thick cream you disliked. We'll check how it wears through the day and under makeup; shine or pilling would count against it.

Ceramides	3 types NP · AP · EOP	5 types NP · AP · EOP · NG · AS

Ceramides help support the barrier that keeps moisture in your skin. Vanicream includes two additional types, giving it a different ceramide blend. I'm keeping ceramides in your replacement to maintain the moisturizing support you already like while trying a formula that may feel more comfortable. We'll judge the result by how your cheeks feel later in the day, rather than the number of types on the label.

CeraVe PM ingredient list

Vanicream ingredient list

Cleanser

FINISH THIS

CeraVe

Hydrating Facial Cleanser

$13.79 / 12 fl oz · finish this bottle

Product page



Your CeraVe cleanser feels comfortable, so I wouldn't replace a bottle you can still use. Once it runs out, try Aveeno Daily Moisturizing Facial Cleanser. It costs less for the same amount, and keeping that saving is worthwhile if it leaves your cheeks just as comfortable. Let's settle the moisturizer change first so we can judge each change separately.

- Finish your CeraVe; there's no cleanser to buy today.
- When it needs replacing, try Aveeno on its own as your evening cleanser. Keep your morning water rinse.
- Use your existing micellar water first on heavier-makeup days. If the new cleanser stings, leaves residue or makes your cheeks tighter, stop and let me know.

Why this change makes sense

Same size, lower price: The 12 oz Aveeno is listed at $11.60 at Walmart; your 12 oz CeraVe is $13.79 at Target. That's $2.19 less per bottle, about 16%. We'll recheck stock and the total before ordering.

A different cleansing formula: Aveeno uses coco-glucoside and sodium cocoyl glutamate to cleanse, with glycerin and oat. CeraVe has a different blend with glycerin and ceramides. That gives us a reasonable lower-cost option to try, but doesn't establish that it will be gentler or more moisturizing for you.

What would make it worth keeping: Your cheeks should feel comfortable after washing, your usual makeup should come off, and you shouldn't need an extra wash. If those stay the same, you get the saving without adding another daily step.

How to use it

1. Gently cleanse with lukewarm water, rinse and pat dry. Follow with moisturizer. Use micellar water first only for heavier makeup.

CeraVe product page

Aveeno product page

Sunscreen

KEEP

Beauty of Joseon

Relief Sun · Rice + Niacinamide

SPF50+ PA++++

Product page



You already like how Relief Sun feels and how it sits under makeup. I'd keep it so you can see how the new moisturizer works with the sunscreen you actually enjoy using. The main thing to plan for is your longer outdoor walks, especially if you'll be sweating.

- Keep your current sunscreen while testing the moisturizer beneath it.
- Take sunscreen with you for longer outings so you can reapply.
- For swimming or outdoor sweating, choose a water-resistant sunscreen and follow its label.

What matters for you

Same sunscreen, updated name: Beauty of Joseon says Rice + Probiotics was renamed Rice + Niacinamide without changing the formula or size. Both names can appear on genuine packaging during the changeover.

Niacinamide: This formula contains niacinamide, and you've said this sunscreen feels comfortable. That's a reason to avoid blaming that ingredient alone for the stinging with CeraVe PM; it doesn't establish what caused it.

Plan for sweat and sun: The brand directs you to use a water-resistant sunscreen for swimming or sweating. Keep a hat and protective clothing in the plan too; sunscreen doesn't make unlimited sun exposure safe.

How to use it

1. After moisturizer, spread a generous, even layer over sun-exposed skin as your final morning skincare step, before makeup.

2. The brand directs reapplication at least every two hours. For swimming or sweating, follow your water-resistant sunscreen's reapplication directions, including after towel drying.

Beauty of Joseon formula, naming update and directions

Treatments

NO ADDITION

No new treatment for now

Focus on comfort before adding another active

You mentioned occasional dullness, but the repeated stinging is what's making your routine difficult to use. I'd get the moisturizer working comfortably first. That keeps the routine within the steps you wanted and gives us a clearer view of whether anything else is worth adding.

- Hold off on buying a brightening serum, exfoliant or retinoid during the moisturizer trial.
- Notice comfort on application, how your cheeks feel later and how your makeup wears.
- Once the routine feels comfortable and consistent, tell me whether dullness still bothers you.

What we're checking first

One change to evaluate: Keeping the other products steady makes it easier to judge the moisturizer. Adding several products at once can also increase irritation, as the American Academy of Dermatology notes.

Comfort before another step: Your goal is one moisturizer for morning and evening and fewer purchases. There's no need to choose a separate treatment before we know whether you still want one.

A test has limits: Trying a new product on a small area can help flag a reaction. It cannot identify the ingredient behind the stinging you've already experienced.

What to do for now

1. There's no treatment to apply. Follow the cleanser, moisturizer and sunscreen steps in your routine.

2. Before using the new moisturizer over your face, the AAD recommends testing a normal amount on a quarter-sized area on the underside of your arm or bend of your elbow twice daily for 7-10 days.

3. If the test causes a reaction, wash it off and stop using it. If irritation persists or worsens, seek a dermatologist's advice.

AAD advice on introducing skincare products

AAD small-area testing guidance

Your daily routine

Stop the lotion that repeatedly stings. Introduce the replacement after the small-area test.

Morning

1. Your usual water rinse. No extra wash.
2. Vanicream Daily Facial Moisturizer, once tested.
3. Beauty of Joseon Relief Sun, before makeup.

Evening

1. Makeup remover when needed, then CeraVe. When finished, try Aveeno Daily Moisturizing Facial Cleanser ($11.60 / 12 oz).
2. Vanicream Daily Facial Moisturizer, once tested.

Using the replacement

1 Test a small area



On your inner arm, apply to a small test spot twice a day for 7-10 days, using your usual amount and thickness. Stop if redness, itching or swelling develops.

2 After rinsing or cleansing



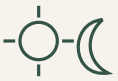
Gently pat your face, leaving it slightly damp. Apply before getting distracted and leaving it to dry. No extra serum or second moisturizer is needed.

3 Spread an even layer



With clean hands, gently spread enough to cover your face comfortably. Avoid hard rubbing and keep product out of your eyes. Follow the label directions.

4 Watch comfort and wear



In the morning, follow with your sunscreen. In the evening, moisturizer is the final step. Check your cheeks later and notice any pilling under sunscreen or makeup.

A small-area test cannot guarantee tolerance. Stop if the product irritates your skin; seek medical advice for concerning, persistent or worsening symptoms.

No check-in is scheduled yet. Arrange a time to review comfortable application, later-day cheek comfort, consistency and makeup wear. Approval does not mean you have started the product.

No order or payment has been placed. Review the exact seller, size, shipping, tax, total and delivery details before paying.

AAD: testing a new skincare product

Sunscreen application guidance